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The 24-hour test: CRA incident readiness for manufacturers selling into the EU

Reporting duties under the Cyber Resilience Act began on 11 September 2026. The hard part is not the form. It is knowing, within hours, what happened and who decides.

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Executive summary

1. Since 11 September 2026, manufacturers of products with digital elements sold in the EU must report actively exploited vulnerabilities and severe incidents affecting the security of their products: an early warning within 24 hours and a notification within 72 hours, followed by a final report.
2. The duty sits with the manufacturer. Many Turkish manufacturers of connected devices, industrial equipment and commercial software have invested in IT security, but have no named owner and no rehearsed path for a product incident.
3. Readiness is demonstrated in an exercise, not in a policy document: a named owner, product and version facts that can be assembled quickly, a clear decision rule, and draft text that can go out on time.

What has changed

The Cyber Resilience Act, Regulation (EU) 2024/2847, sets cybersecurity requirements for products with digital elements placed on the EU market. Most of its product requirements apply from 11 December 2027, but its reporting obligations started earlier, on 11 September 2026.

When a manufacturer becomes aware of an actively exploited vulnerability in its product, or of a severe incident affecting the product's security, it must send an early warning within 24 hours, a fuller notification within 72 hours, and a final report within the periods the regulation sets. Reports go through the single reporting platform operated with ENISA to the competent national CSIRT.

Scope is decided product by product. Not every software business is in scope, and the regulation contains specific provisions for smaller companies. Fear-led readings help no one; a clear scope check does.

Why 24 hours is hard

Twenty-four hours is short when the facts are scattered. Someone has to learn of the exploitation, often from a customer, researcher or supplier. Someone has to work out which products and versions are affected. Someone has to decide whether the reporting threshold is met, and someone has to submit. In many manufacturers these people have never been in the same room for this purpose.

IT security teams and managed security providers protect the company's own systems. A product incident is different: it concerns devices and software in customers' hands, release histories and component lists that live with engineering, and customer communication that lives with sales or support.

The gap is rarely technology. It is ownership, information and rehearsal.

Five common misreadings

"Our SOC or security provider covers this." They cover your IT estate. Product facts and the reporting decision remain with the manufacturer.

"The CRA starts in 2027." The product requirements do. Reporting started in September 2026.

"We only report confirmed breaches." An actively exploited vulnerability in your product can trigger reporting even when your own systems were never breached.

"Every software company is in scope." Scope depends on the product and how it reaches the EU market. A scope check comes first.

"A written procedure proves readiness." Only an exercise shows whether the clock can actually be met.

Questions for the leadership team

1. Which of our products and versions are on the EU market and still supported?
2. Who is the named owner of a product security incident, including outside working hours?
3. How would we learn that a vulnerability is being exploited: customers, researchers, suppliers?
4. Can we identify affected versions and components within hours?
5. Who decides that the reporting threshold has been met?
6. Who submits the report, and do they already have access to the reporting channel?
7. How and when do we inform affected customers and users?
8. When did we last rehearse a product incident end to end?

What a good first step produces

A useful first step is a realistic tabletop exercise on one product family, run against the 24- and 72-hour timeline. It should leave the team with a map of in-scope products and versions, named roles and an escalation path, prepared reporting drafts, and a short list of gaps ranked by consequence.

Ganrich Advisory designs and facilitates this exercise and turns its findings into a scoped readiness plan. We do not certify products, operate round-the-clock incident response or take over the manufacturer’s reporting duty; specialist security and legal partners are appointed where needed.

Start a conversation

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About this paper. This paper reflects official sources checked on 21–23 October 2026. It is general information, not legal, customs, tax or engineering advice. Rules, thresholds and dates change; confirm them against official sources before acting. It describes no client work or results.

Sources: European Commission, Cyber Resilience Act – reporting obligations: digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/cra-reporting · Regulation (EU) 2024/2847 (Cyber Resilience Act), EUR-Lex

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